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What is Tether (USDT), How to Get It and How to Store It

28 comments | Antonio Madeira | 13 Mar 2019 | 432.37 k

What is Tether (USDT)?

If you, reader, have been interacting with cryptocurrencies and assets for any length of time - and especially if you've been trading cryptoassets - the utility of stablecoins has probably become clear by now.

As long as you don't need to exchange your crypto for actual fiat money, stablecoins allow you to mimic the function of cash *within* the crypto-universe - specifically, the function of stability. And as much as we all love crypto, stability is something most of us need - and most cryptos are distinctly unstable.

And among stablecoins stands Tether (or USDT), both loved and dreaded, still bigger than any other stablecoin. Tether has been around for a while, with the first USDT "minted" in 2014.

Tether tokens are backed 1:1 by the dollars that customers or investors put up when buying them. It does not have its own blockchain, but rather functions within Bitcoin's script as a second-level currency. This layer atop Bitcoin's is called the Omni Layer.

Tether's relationship with the cryptoasset industry might be described as permanently ambivalent. Although the most widely used stablecoin, there has been rife speculation that Tether does not actually back their issuing with real dollars from customers or investors - that they are simply printing money!

Entire blogs have been dedicated to gleaning the details of this supposedly fraudulent operation, and many have speculated that Tether would someday bring down the whole cryptoasset industry.

This is because, for years, Tether and the closely associated Bitfinex exchange - who have shared banking relationships and management - have struggled to maintain long term access to regulated banking. In the first half of 2019, Tether's banking arrangements have seemed to stabilize - but who knows for how long.

Tether's Elastic Tether - The Tether Premium

During the most recent of Tether's major banking concerns, the stablecoin's price diverged significantly from its 1:1 USD valuation by as much as five percent. This premium caused USDT-paired bitcoin to trade a hundred or more dollars more than USD-paired bitcoin, creating a fair bit of havoc in the markets at the time.

Because of the possibility of such price fluctuations, it is probably a good idea when using Tether to remain vigilant - especially if using it for long term storage.

How to Get It

Despite all these worries, Tether has not yet imploded in a fiery wreck. So if you want to hazard using it, here's how.

By far the easiest way to acquire USDT is by buying it on nearly any cryptoasset exchange that you're currently using. It is almost universally available on prominent (and even not so prominent) exchanges. It can be bought with both fiat currency and many cryptoassets.

Although Tether is subjected to ever-increasing competition from other altcoins - both centralized and algorithmic - Tether will almost always be available.

Many altcoins trade directly against Tether, which tends to make these markets more liquid and volatile. This is because many traders and investors hold Tether in order stay out of markets; and trading Tether directly for an altcoin instead of needing to make the extra step of buying bitcoin or Ether is significantly simpler.

Direct From the Source

The other way to get Tether is by buying it directly from the company itself.

Mostly, though, buying direct from Tether is for those with deep pockets. For quite some time, redeeming Tether for actual dollars was not available. Late last year, the service resumed - but only for those holding a minimum of 100,000 Tether tokens.

Dealing directly with the Tether gateway requires a full registration (with fee) and KYC/AML submission. Furthermore, US citizens or residents are barred from using Tether's official gateway.

If you still want to buy directly from Tether, however, here's how to do so:

Part 1 - Create an account with Tether.io

Step 1: Click here to go to Tether.to

Step 2: Click "**Signup**" to create an account

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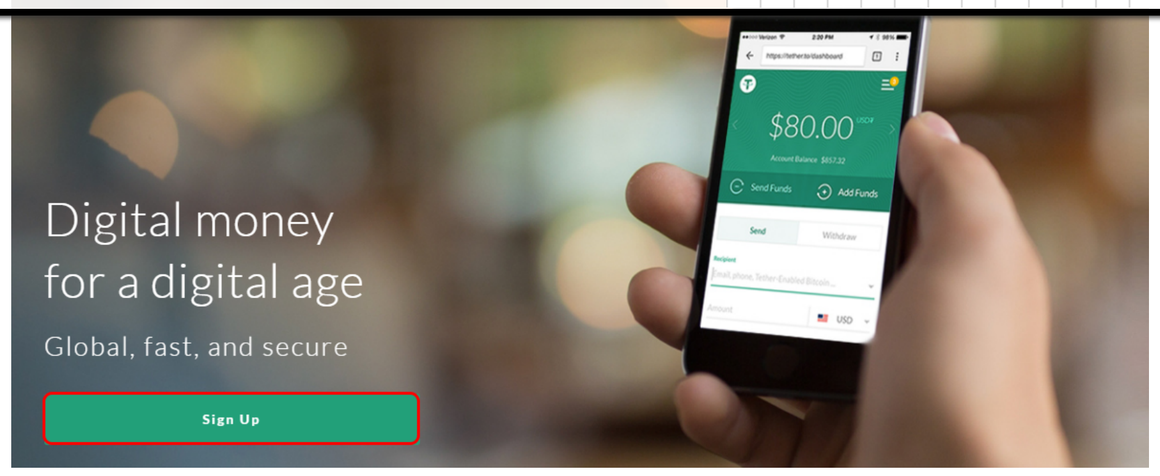
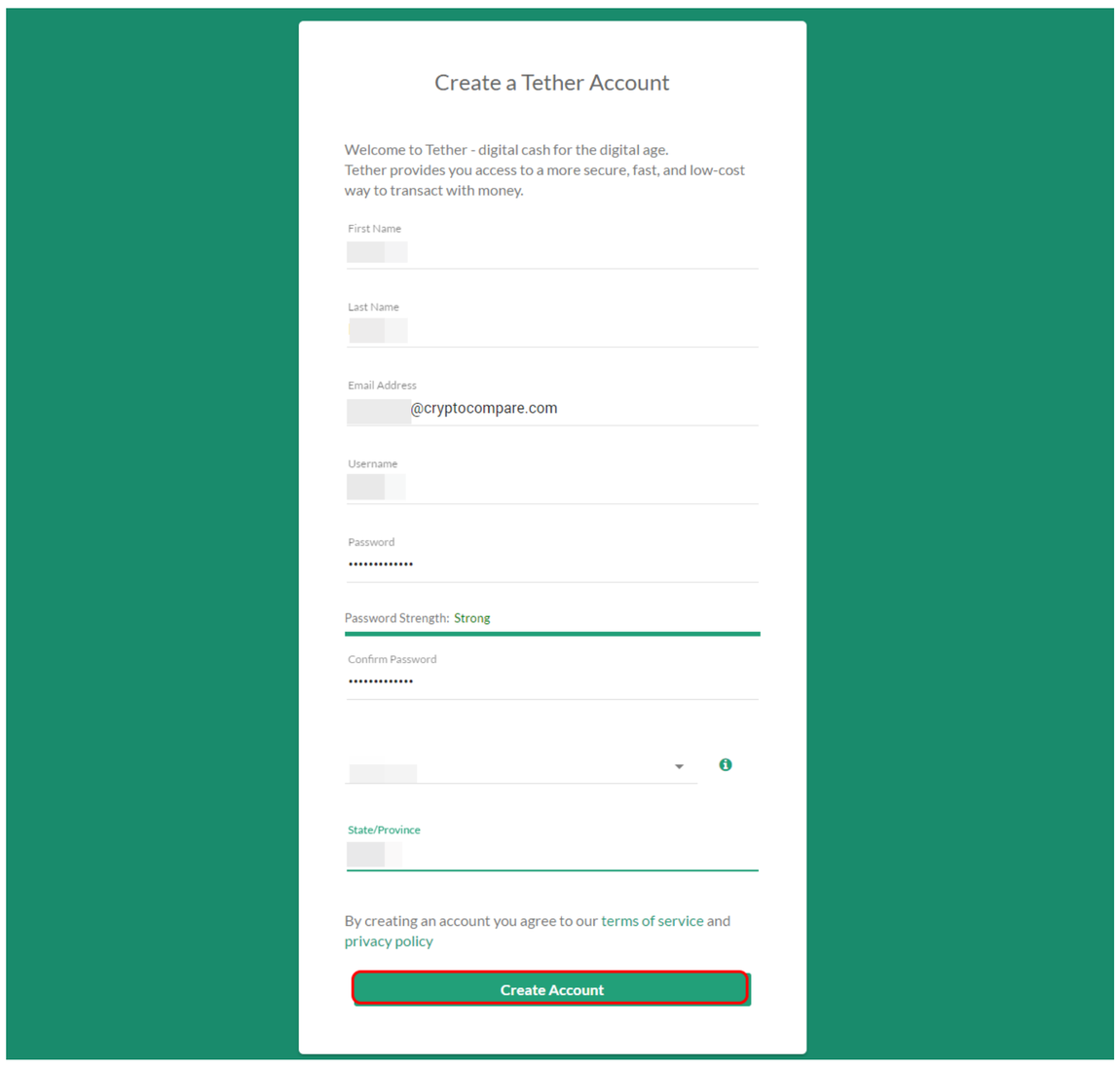
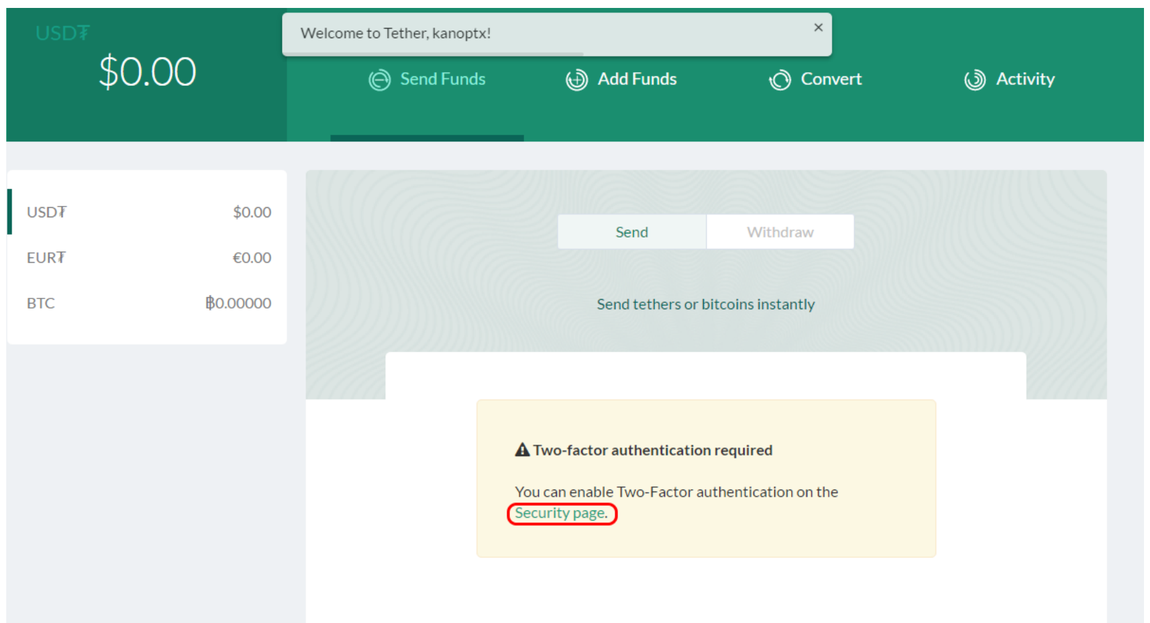


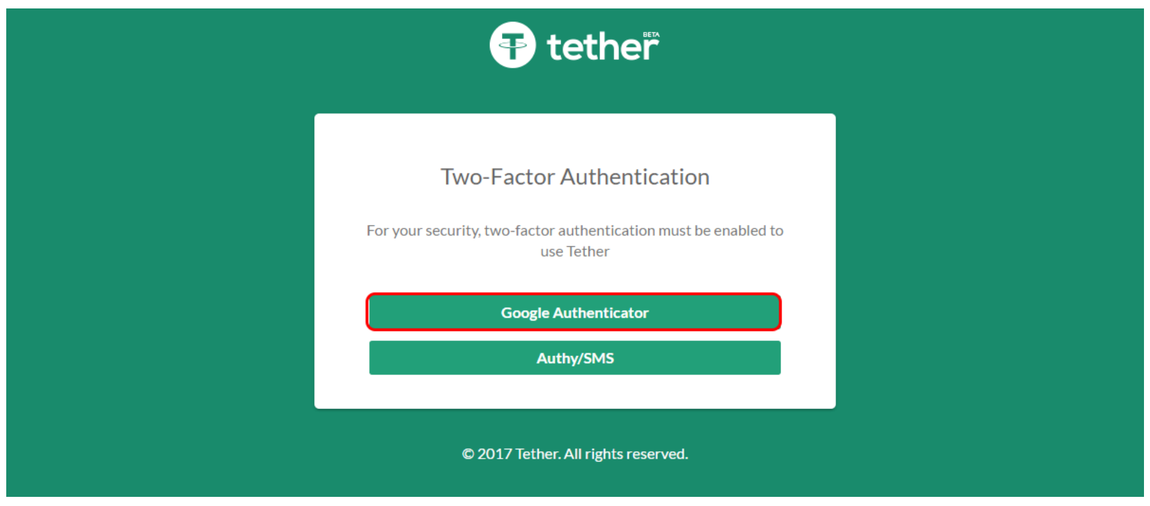
Step 3: Fill in your personal details and click "**Create Account**"



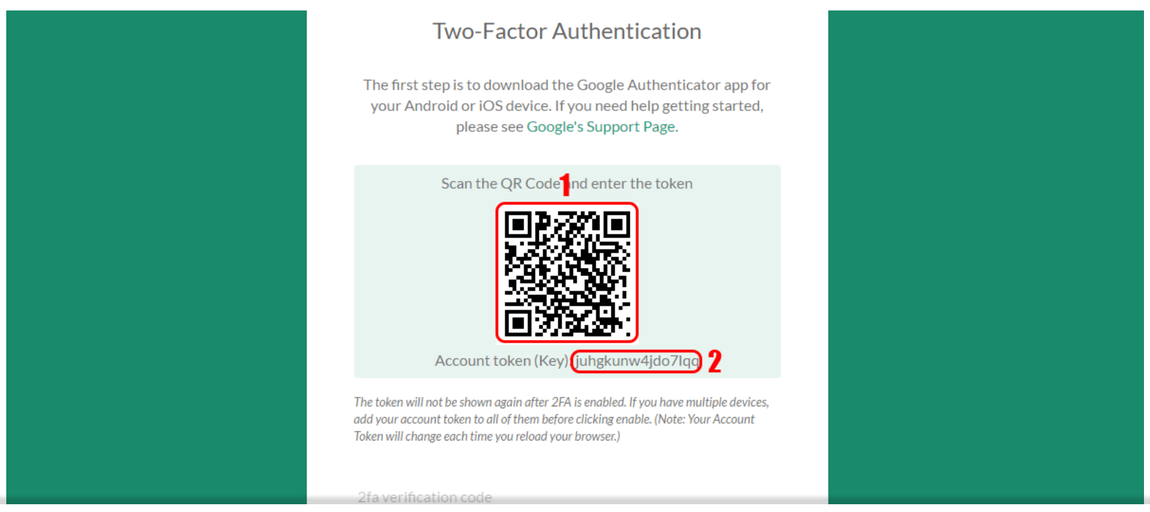
Step 4: Your account will be created. In order to use it, you must activate 2-factor authentication, which will also add an extra layer of security to your account. Click "**Security Page**"



Step 5: Choose the method to activate 2-FA with. We're going to choose "**Google Authenticator**"



Step 6: Scan the QR-code **(1)** or type the code **(2)** in Google Authenticator



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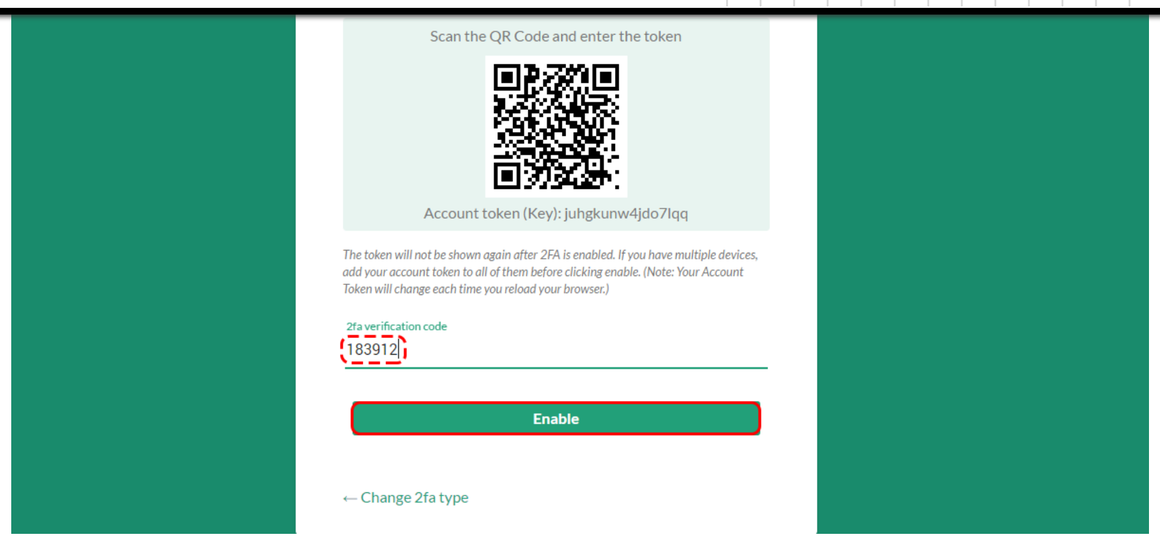
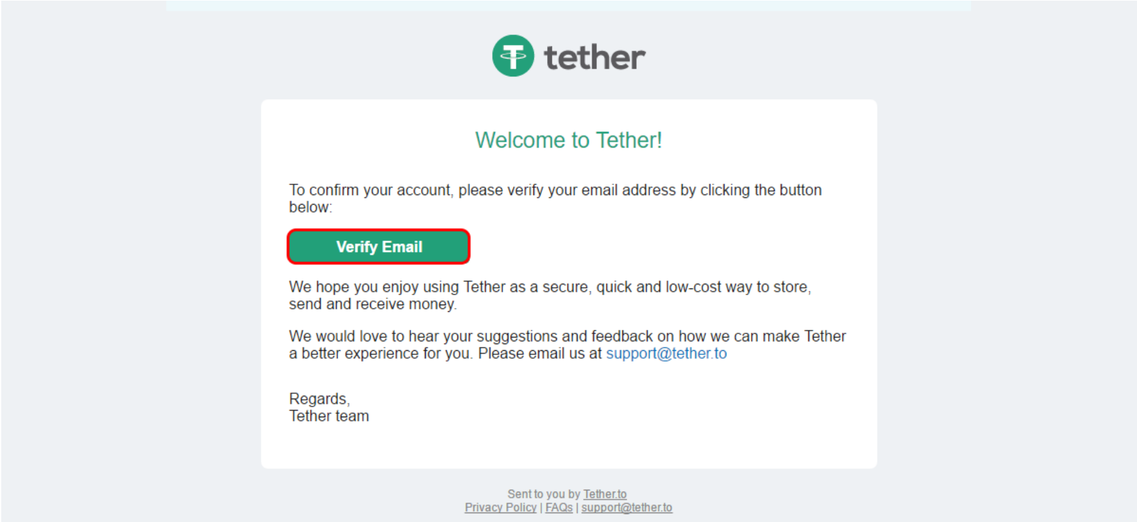


2-FA is now active. You'll need your phone to access your account, so make sure you don't lose it.

Step 8: Now go to your email address and click the activation link sent by Tether

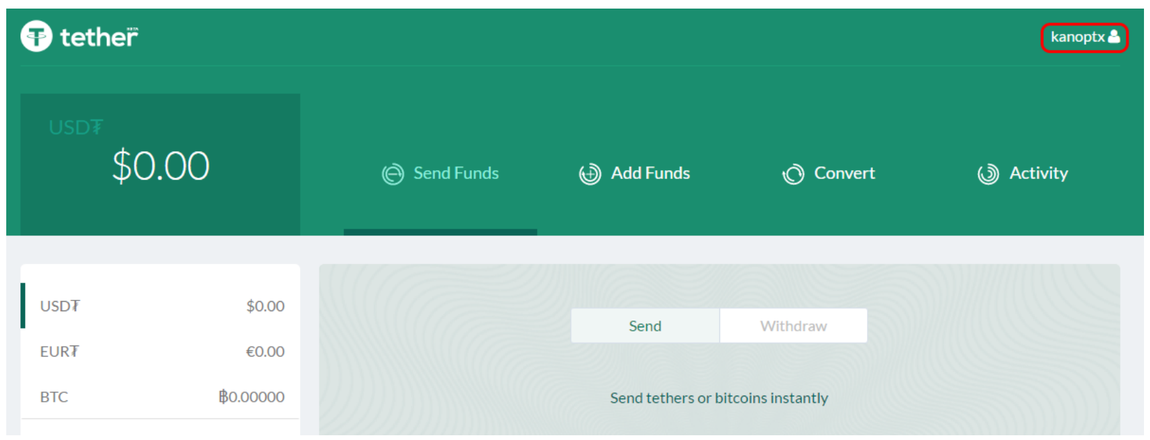


Your email will be confirmed

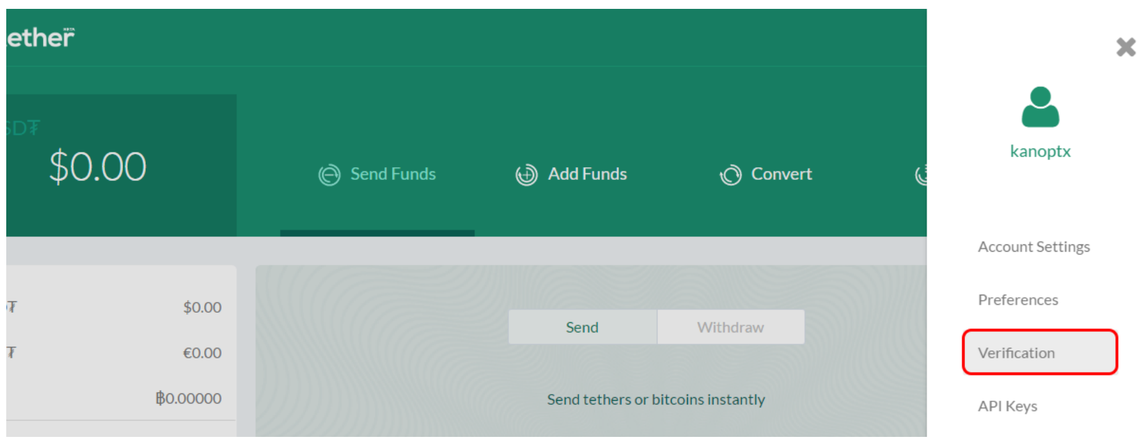
Part 2 - Verify your Identity

In order to deposit or withdraw USD, you must first go through a verification process

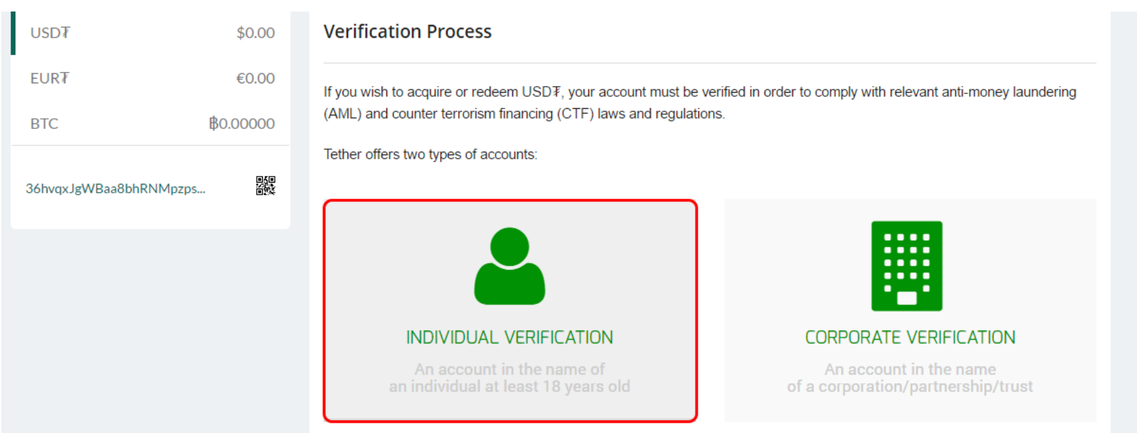
Step 1: Click "**yourusername**" on the upper right corner



Step 2: Click "**Verification**"

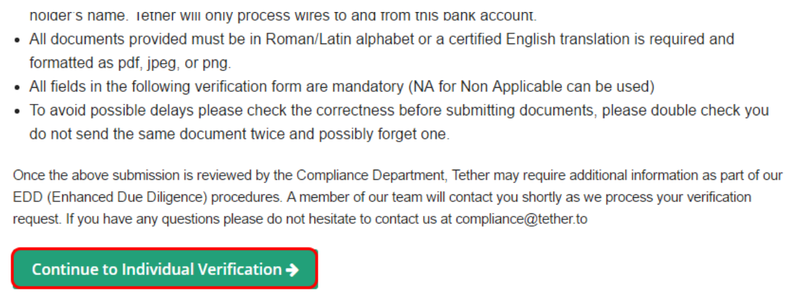


Step 3: Choose "**Individual Verification**"



Step 4: Now scroll down. Take some time to read the information displayed as it will help with the verification process

Step 5: Click "**Continue to Individual Verification**"



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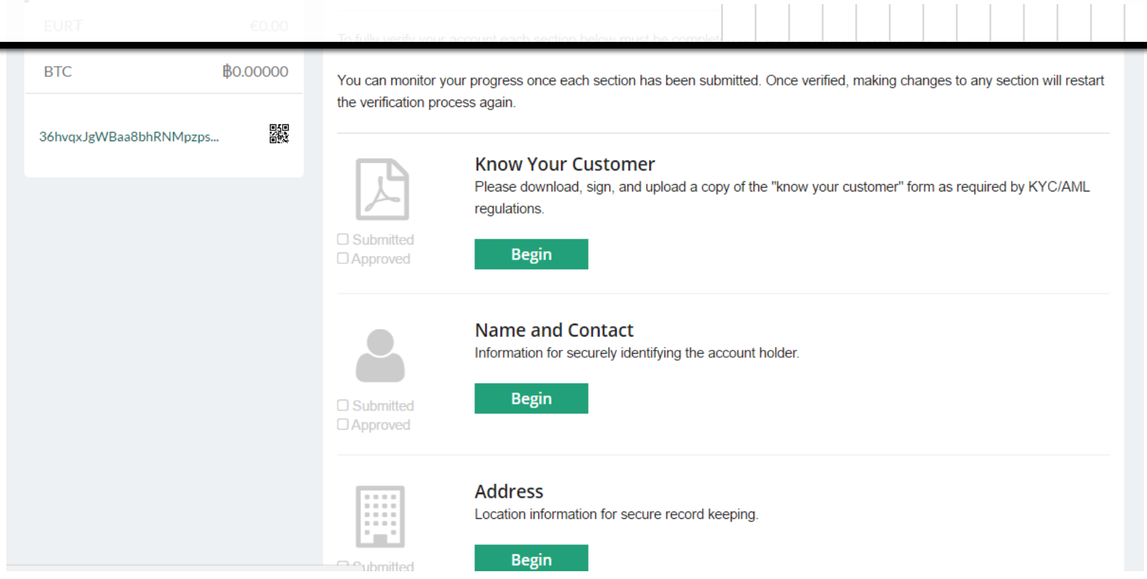
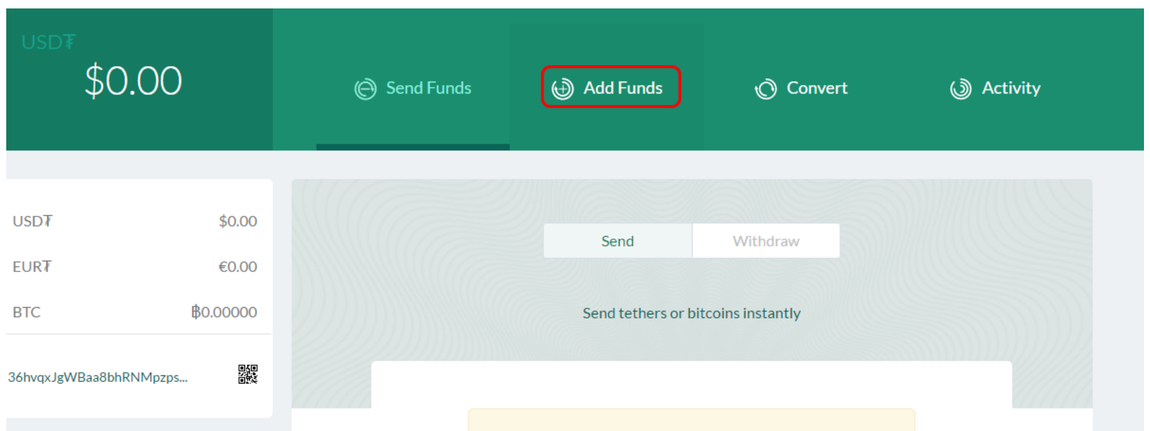


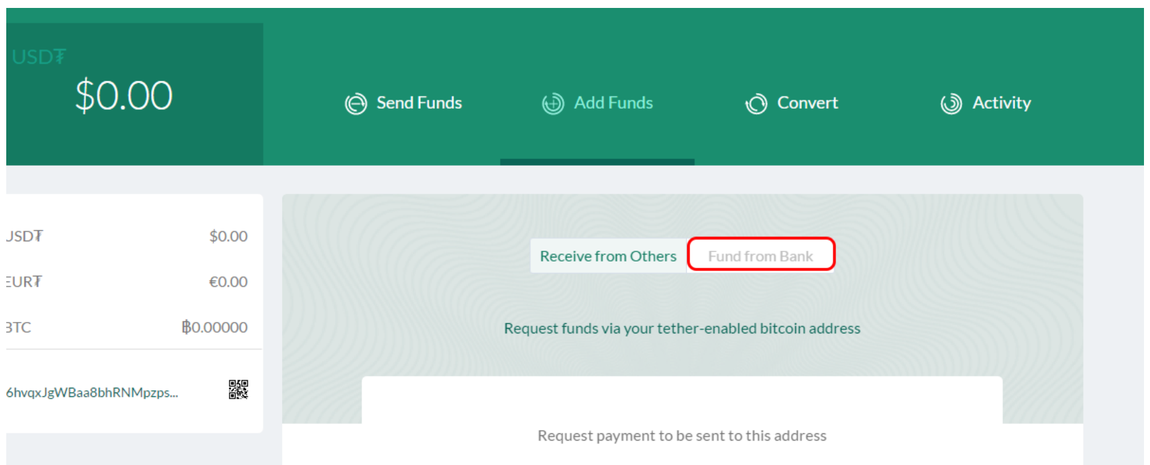
Part 3 - Send/Recieve/Withdraw

Sending and
recieving
USDT is pretty straight forward. You will be given a Bitcoin wallet address which you can use to
recieve
USDT funds. All you need to do is go to "**Add Funds**":

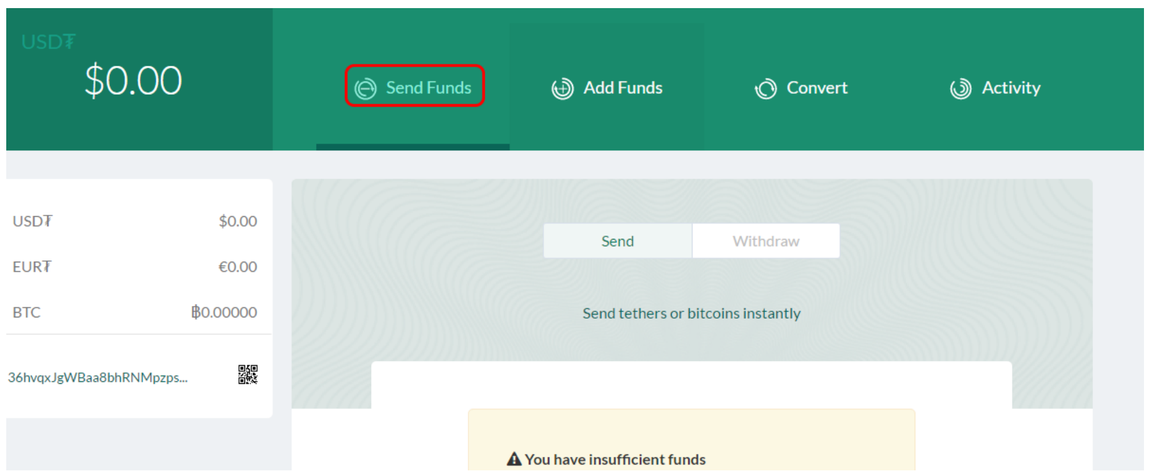


You will be shown a wallet address which can be used to recieve USDT or Bitcoin:

To Recieve funds from your bank account click "**Fund from Bank**" and follow the instructions shown

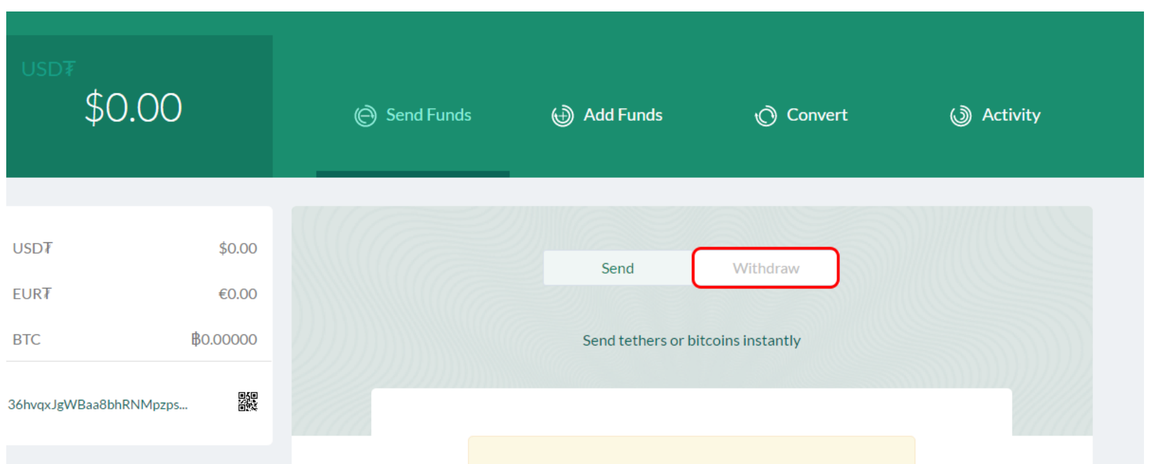


To send USDT or Bitcoin simply go to "**Send Funds**"



Then simply enter the Bitcoin address and amount of USDT you want to send.

To convert and send USDT to your bank account click "**Withdraw**" and follow the instructions shown



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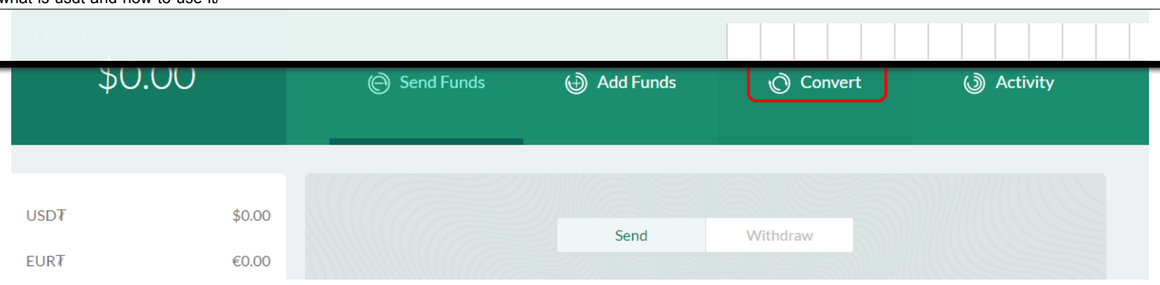

And that's it! You can now use USDT freely. Remember that to convert USDT to USD and vice-versa you need to verify your account.

Comments

What is your opinion on What is Tether (USDT), How to Get It and How to Store It? (You will be banned if you post affiliate / referral links. Please keep the conversation civilized and remember, we're all in this together!)

Post

CryptoMinnow
4 years ago

The description of Tether now needs updating to remove the claim of 1:1 USD reserves
Source:
https://tether.to

View Edits

reply Agree

info.coinpedia
4 years ago

New reports indicate that there is an increase in crypto theft and hack. Recently researcher discovers four fake crypto wallets apps such as Tether, MetaMask, and Neo on play store and future more.

Here you can find info: http://bit.ly/2Kbhhmy

reply Agree

princa_jaba
4 years ago

One question: Who the hell is buying Tether? Wash trading scheme, fake value, ponzi sceme, growing supply... New paper promises. The history repeats itself.Remember the story about Chianese Emperor who print so much papers, more than coins in the treasure. Anyway exchanges do whatever they want with prlces. Markets are everything but fair ...

reply Agree

briancagging
4 years ago

hello everyone...
Have you been loosing to your broker ?.Do you want to have a life investment?.Do you need a good strategy and trends to trade ?.Do you need a account management service on your trading account either old or new ?
Here is the opportunity to make a life investment .either you have loose before or you are having problems with your withdraws you can contact binanceaccounts@insurer.com and they will teach you trading system that mines cryptocurrencies, this has been so helpful to many for the past 6 months now.i recommend this trading system to every trader and potential investors for my trading guidance with best strategy. NB:Wanting to trade you must be up 18 years old and you must have a valid country I.D card. If you meet all this and you wish to trade you can hit him up with those information provided above

reply Agree

kkratky
4 years ago

Why is Tether Limited doing this? Can we be sure they do not stop tomorrow?

reply Agree

alex-vela
5 years ago

BIG scam, claiming that they back every usdt with a us dollar held in reserves is a scam... it couldn't be more clearly... it's been debated several times.... MOVE ON with this token,,, the project developer or the person who draft the white paper is probably banging his head on how stupid his statement was...

reply Agree 2 2

caolyhuynh
5 years ago

Please help me ..

reply Agree

BlockchainMaster
5 years ago

Projects with rock stable exchange rate are future of cryptocurrencies. Tether is a archetype of this kind. There are already other projects with stable rate like decentralized storage cloud Nebula Network based on its own blockchain :)

reply Agree

inaamfirst
5 years ago

Use it through trading sites like binance & crytopia for better and safe experience.

1 reply Agree 1 1

breakthecross313
5 years ago

Recommend using Binance : https://www.binance.com/?ref=12138393 .
Binance does not require verification for up to 2 BTC worth of withdrawals per day.

Happy Trading

1 reply Agree 1 1

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I advise that you use Binance (http://bit.ly/2B6g4XJ) to track this crypto for at least 24 hours before diving in. But while you're there pick up some $VIBE and $WTC for long-term holds. Just trust me.

reply Agree 3

sitemagik
5 years ago

Tether is a Ponzi scheme. Their claims of being backed by bank deposits are false. Do your research and don't get burnt by this scam.

reply Agree 5 2

leon
5 years ago

test

reply Agree

pilar.alurraldec
5 years ago

I reccomend binance, super reliable and easy to use. Also the phone app is really user-friendly. Here's my referral link
https://www.binance.com/?ref=17735822

reply Agree 2

adam.saltiel
5 years ago

"We're all in this together"? That is not so clear. cryptocompare, to retain credibility, should update this article as there are grave concerns about the use of USD Tether, as highlighted in this article:-
https://medium.com/@untetheredbtc/how-the-tether-usdt-distribution-system-works-84a5c673bec0
And this article:-
https://hackernoon.com/open-questions-for-factom-53e4eeaafdb
The issues are complex and I am not sure that the author "Un Tether", is correct in every regard, he does not and cannot give any indication of the value of cryptocurrencies, nor do I expect him to as no one person can.
What is clear is that people should think through their aims very carefully. And test any exchanges they might want to use to perform according to those aims.

reply Agree 5

brybaby66
5 years ago

I need some assistance I have sent USDT to a BTC address, these wallets have addresses that validate to each other, but the wallets are not compatible for receiving coins. You'll need to research how to remove a private key from a Bitcoin address and import it into a USDT wallet to recover these coins. You may want to contact someone from the USDT community for help. Can you help me get MY $310 that never posted

2 replies Agree

lorvicyap
5 years ago

tether.io?

1 reply Agree

martygreen0517
5 years ago

There are some significant concerns about Tether and market manipulation. Users and readers should beware and perform due diligence. It would be helpful if CryptoCompare could compare the pros and cons in future articles if possible.

reply Agree 6

2ndflight
5 years ago

Do you have any reading suggestion on trading with USDT on Bittrex VS USD on Bitfinex?

reply Agree

rubyw6602
5 years ago

I trade (that is, buy and sell bitcoins) anonymously from liviacoins.com My last trade with LiviaCoins was completed in 30 minutes.

reply Agree 2

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